The Call and the Covenant

Genesis 12 · Genesis 15 · Genesis 17

The big idea: God chose to rescue the world through one man. He called Abram, promised him a land, a people, and a blessing for every nation, counted him righteous because he believed, and swore by himself to keep his word.

Before you meet: Read

Genesis 12:1–9 | Genesis 15:1–21 | Romans 4:1–8

Open (5 minutes)

Have you ever waited a long time for something you were promised? What did the waiting do to you?

Observe (fill in from the passage)

"Go from your country and your kindred and your father's house to the _____ that I will show you." *(Genesis 12:1)*

"And in you all the _____ of the earth shall be blessed." *(Genesis 12:3)*

"And he believed the LORD, and he counted it to him as _____." *(Genesis 15:6)*

"A smoking fire pot and a flaming _____ passed between these _____." *(Genesis 15:17)*

Discuss

1. Abram's family "served other gods." What does it tell you about grace that God called Abram before Abram was looking for him? *Joshua 24:2; Genesis 12:1–4*

2. In the covenant ceremony, Abram was asleep and only God passed between the pieces. What does that say about who keeps God's promises? *Genesis 15:12–18*

3. "He counted it to him as righteousness." In your own words, what does it mean to be justified by faith? *Genesis 15:6; Romans 4:4–5*

Memory verse

> *"And he believed the LORD, and he counted it to him as righteousness."*
>
> **Genesis 15:6**

Pray

Thank God that he called you before you were looking for him, and that he counts righteous everyone who trusts his promise. Ask him for faith to believe what he has said.

LEADER NOTES · WEEK 11

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Session plan (about 45 minutes)

5 min	Welcome, opening prayer, and the Open question.
10 min	Read Genesis 12:1–9 and 15:1–18 aloud together.
5 min	Observe: work through the fill-ins together. Use the answer key below.
20 min	Discuss: choose three of the questions.
5 min	Pray together. Introduce the memory verse and next week's reading (Genesis 21:1–7 and 22:1–19).

Main points to land

1. God made three promises that run through the whole Bible: a land, a people, and a blessing for all the families of the earth. Paul calls Genesis 12:3 the gospel preached beforehand (Gal. 3:8).
2. Abram was justified by faith alone. He believed, and God counted it to him as righteousness (Gen. 15:6; Rom. 4:5). Faith receives that righteousness; it does not supply it (WCF 11.1).
3. Only God passed between the pieces. The covenant rests on God's faithfulness, and Abram's lies and the Hagar plan could not undo it (Gen. 15:17; Heb. 6:13).

Core doctrine to teach

The Covenant of Grace CORE DOCTRINE 6 OF 26

After the fall, God bound himself by solemn promise to save a people for himself. He announced that promise in Eden (Gen. 3:15), confirmed it to Abraham, and kept it in Jesus Christ. In this covenant God freely offers life and salvation to sinners through Christ, and he calls them to trust him. *Genesis 12:1–3; 15:6; 17:7; Galatians 3:7–9, 29*

Answer key (Observe)

1. land
2. families
3. righteousness
4. torch; pieces

Questions people will ask

Why did God pick Abram? Was he better than everyone else?

No. His family worshiped idols, and he lied about his wife soon after he obeyed. God chose him by grace, and he chose one man so that the blessing would reach every nation through him (Gen. 12:3). Week 13 says more about God's choosing. Keep the group on the main point: God starts the rescue.

Closing prayer

Father, thank you for calling Abram when he was not looking for you, and for calling us the same way. Thank you that you swore by yourself to keep your promise, and that you count righteous all who believe. Give each of us faith to take you at your word. Amen.